NovaCart Support Playbook: Payments, Billing & Disputes

Category: Payments & Billing | **Document ID:** SOP-OPS-PB-05 | **Version:** 2026.4 | **Scope:** Tier 1-3 Support

Section 1: Payment Architecture, Gateway Rails & Decline Codes

1.1 Overview: This SOP establishes procedures for managing electronic transactions, payment gateway declines, authorization holds, multi-currency conversion, and invoice adjustments across NovaCart.

1.2 Payment Rail Topology

- **Card Networks:** Visa, MasterCard, American Express, RuPay processed via multi-gateway redundant acquirers.
- **Direct Bank Rails / Wallets:** UPI, Net Banking, Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, and NovaCart Stored Value Wallet.
- **Deferred / Credit Rails:** Buy-Now-Pay-Later (BNPL), No-Cost Equated Monthly Installments (EMI), and Cash on Delivery (COD).

1.3 Common Decline Code Resolution Matrix

Gateway Code	Customer Error Message	Underlying Technical Reason	Agent Resolution Protocol
`CARD_DECLINED_05`	Transaction Declined	Generic bank decline (insufficient funds, risk block).	Advise customer to contact issuing bank to authorize e-comm purchase.
`3DS_FAIL_TIMEOUT`	Authentication Failed	OTP expired or 3D Secure session timed out.	Recommend clearing browser cache or using NovaCart mobile app.
`INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS`	Payment Incomplete	Account balance insufficient for authorization amount.	Suggest split payment or secondary card/UPI payment method.
`FRAUD_RISK_BLOCK`	Security Verification Failed	Internal fraud engine detected high velocity or IP anomaly.	Review fraud score; whitelist if verified legitimate customer.

Section 2: Authorization Holds vs. Captured Funds & Double Charges

2.1 Understanding Two-Phase Payments: NovaCart operates on an Authorization & Capture model. An initial authorization places a temporary ring-fence on customer credit lines; actual funds capture occurs only upon physical warehouse order dispatch.

2.2 Resolving Duplicate Charge Allegations

- **Step 1: OMS Cross-Reference:** Query the customer's User ID across all active, cancelled, and abandoned shopping carts within the last 48 hours to verify if twin orders were placed.
- **Step 2: Bank Descriptor Inspection:** Verify whether customer sees two 'Settled/Debit' line items or one 'Pending Pre-Auth' hold and one 'Debit' line item on their mobile banking application.
- **Step 3: Pre-Auth Void Execution:** If a ghost hold exists from an abandoned checkout attempt, CSR triggers an automated `VOID_AUTHORIZATION` call to release the bank hold immediately.

2.3 Settlement Lifecycle Comparison

Transaction Stage	Customer Bank Statement Display	NovaCart Financial Ledger	Customer Fund Status
Order Placement	Pending / Hold / Reserved	Pre-authorization approved; $0 captured.	Funds held by customer bank, not NovaCart.
Order Dispatched	Settled / Debited / Captured	Gross funds settled into merchant escrow.	Funds fully transferred to NovaCart account.
Order Cancelled Pre-Dispatch	Pending status drops off (24-72h)	Pre-authorization voided via API.	Hold released automatically back to available balance.
Post-Dispatch Refund	Refund / Credit adjustment	Reverse settlement executed to gateway.	Reflected as fresh positive line item credit.

Section 3: BNPL, EMI Installments & Cash on Delivery Discrepancies

3.1 Buy-Now-Pay-Later (BNPL) & EMI Structures: NovaCart partners with banking institutions and fintech lenders to offer installment credit at checkout.

3.2 Troubleshooting Installment Discrepancies

- **Interest Subvention Delays:** In 'No-Cost EMI' promotions, the total upfront interest is discounted directly from the retail merchandise price at checkout. Reassure customers seeing gross bank interest charges that their item base price was reduced by the exact corresponding amount.
- **BNPL Late Fee Disputes:** NovaCart cannot waive third-party fintech late payment fines directly. CSR must route customer through the designated BNPL Partner Resolution Bridge.

3.3 Cash on Delivery (COD) Discrepancy Protocols

Discrepancy Type	Driver Behavior / System Log	Carrier Investigation	Customer Remediation
Overcharging by Driver	Driver demanded cash above invoice total.	Carrier station manager investigates driver.	Refund excess amount to NovaCart Wallet instantly.
Cash Paid, Marked Undelivered	Customer paid cash, driver marked as failed attempt.	Conduct physical cash reconciliation at hub.	Audit courier branch cash vault; confirm delivery status.
Counterfeit Note Allegation	Driver claims customer provided fake note.	Driver must present disputed currency to depot.	Customer provided option to switch to digital UPI payment.
Refusal to Provide Change	Driver lacks exact cash denomination.	Carrier mandated to provide exact change.	Excess rounded cash credited directly to customer wallet.

Section 4: Chargeback Defense, Invoicing Adjustments & Tax Exemption

4.1 Chargeback Defense Operations: When a cardholder initiates a dispute directly with their issuing bank under Card Network Rules, NovaCart has a strictly timed window to submit representment evidence.

4.2 Representment Evidence Package Requirements

- **Friendly Fraud (Claiming Non-Receipt):** Compulsory submission of carrier Proof of Delivery (POD) signed by recipient, driver GPS drop-off geofence confirmation, and matching customer IP address log during checkout.
- **Unrecognized Transaction:** Submission of 3D Secure 2.0 liability shift certificates showing customer passed biometrics/bank SMS OTP authentication successfully.

4.3 Tax Invoicing & B2B Commercial Billing Adjustments

Invoice Modification Request	Statutory Eligibility	Operational Method	System SLA
Add Corporate GST / Tax ID	Permitted within 7 calendar days of order placement.	CSR edits tax field; triggers regenerated e-invoice.	Generated within 4 hours.
Change Billing Address	Permitted if state tax jurisdiction remains unchanged.	OMS Re-billing module.	Immediate regenerated PDF.
Tax Exemption Certificate	Registered non-profits / educational institutions.	Tax compliance desk manual verification.	24 business hours review.
Credit Note Generation	Mandatory for all partial or full returns.	Automated reverse billing credit memo.	Triggered on refund settlement.

> ***Regulatory Notice:*** *Invoices for delivered shipments cannot be deleted, backdated, or cancelled from the financial system under federal anti-tax evasion compliance mandates.*